

Common Service Centres (CSCs) which serve as "highways to the government".

MAHILA SAMRAS GRAM PANCHAYATS

Under the Samras scheme, villagers choose their ward members and sarpanch unanimously, without going to polls. The Panchayat, Rural Housing & Rural Development Department provide incentives to the gram panchayats which becomes samras for the first time, second, third and fourth times continuously.

An increase of 1.5 times in these incentive grants has been made as per the latest resolution. Since the scheme came into effect in Oct 2001, incentives of Rs 308.32 crore have been given to 14,669 Samras Gram Panchayats (including 768 Mahila Samras Gram Panchayats).

These incentives are used for the common development of works of the village like providing clean drinking water system, internal approach road, street light facilities, primary school rooms, health centre facilities, water harvesting system, Panchayat house, public toilets, disposal of polluted water, etc.

EMPOWERING VILLAGES THROUGH E-GRAM

E-Gram VishwagramYojana, an initiative of the Gujarat Government, was launched in 2004-05 with the motive to provide e-services in rural areas on the lines of urban areas.

14,179 eGram centres provide 60 services digitally in rural areas, similar to the e-services available in urban areas. The services includes G2C (Government to Citizen) services like birth certificate, death certificate, income certificate, temporary residence certificate, copy of village form no. 6, 7/12 and 8-A, online registration for i-Kisan Portal/ PM Kisan Sahay Yojana, Aadhaar card registration, upgradation and KYC, E-shram card, Aayushman Card, etc. and B2C (Business to Citizen) services like booking e-tickets for bus, train and flights, online bill payment (telephone, mobile phone and DTH) and premium collection of LIC or other private insurance companies. It has now been planned to increase these services to around 200, to be digitally provided to the people living in villages through e-Gram centres.

Till date 87.45 crore transactions have been made through e-gram centres from the year 2004 to 2022.

PAYMENTS THROUGH DSC IN 15TH FINANCE COMMISSION

A budgetary provision of Rs 15,600 crore has been made under the 15th Finance Commission to ensure a sound financial management system in the panchayats through online payments on eGram Swaraj Portal, thereby fostering increased accountability and transparency.

Complete transactions of payments are made online through the medium of Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) on eGram Swaraj Portal. Gujarat is one of the leading states in making online payment through DSC.

Till now, payments of Rs 1329.01 crore have been made digitally using this portal by 13,160 gram panchayats that use e-Gram Swaraj portal.

TIRTH GRAM PAAVAN GRAM SCHEMES

The Tirth Gram Yojana and Paavan Gram Yojana have been formulated to enhance mutual harmony among the people living in rural areas and encourage efforts for the overall development of villages.

- Under Tirth Gram Yojana, which was launched in year 2004, incentive of Rs 2 lakh is given if there is no offence registered in last five years, within the limits of gram panchayat. So far 1019 villages have been declared as Tirth Gram.
- Under Paavan Gram Yojana, which was launched in year 2006-07, incentive of Rs 1 lakh is given, if there is no offence registered in last three years, within the limits of gram panchayat. So far, 405 villages have been declared as Paavan Gram.

FORMATION OF NEW GRAM PANCHAYATS

From Sep 2021 to Dec 2021, the state government has split 230 gram panchayat



groups that led to the formation of 279 new gram panchayats. Now 14,529 gram panchayats exist in the state.

The creation of more new gram panchayats will bring huge relief to the people, who would have otherwise to travel long distances for various government works and services.

Filling up vacant posts of panchayat cadre

The process of recruitment to more than 13,000 vacant posts of panchayat cadre is in under process which is to be completed in next six months. It will lead to a marked improvement in overall governance and service delivery to the people living in rural areas.This will also provide huge opportunity of employment to the youths of Gujarat.

Further, to improve governance and administration in rural areas, emphasis is given on filling up key vacant posts such as Taluka Development Officer. Presently, 100 % posts of Taluka Development Officer have been filled in the state.

ROBUST & MODERN INFRASTRUCTURE

The state government emphasises on providing robust, accessible infrastructure with modern amenities at gram, taluka and district panchayat levels.

Previously, the power to sanction and approve gram panchayat building was at the panchayat department level, which led to complex and delayed decision making. To speed up the construction of GP building in a time bound manner, power to sanction and approve GP building is decentralised to district panchayat by the present government. Significantly, more than 2700 GP buildings are planned to be constructed in next six months, through convergence of various schemes and funds available at the district level such as MGNREGA, 15th FC, DMF and state government funds. It will be a huge improvement from 2400 GP buildings constructed in the last five years.